

Emacs String Manipulation

s.el is an Emacs string manipulation library released under the GNU General Public License v3.0. It has been written by Magnar Sveen and the latest tagged release is v1.12.0. The source code is available at <https://github.com/magnars/s.el>. In this article, we shall explore the various string handling functions provided by the s.el library.

The s.el package is available in Milkypostman's Emacs Lisp Package Archive (MELPA) and in the Marmalede repo. You can install the same using the following command inside GNU Emacs:

```
M-x package-install s
```

You can also copy the s.el source file to your Emacs load path to use it. If you are using Cask, then you can add the following command to your Cask file:

```
(depends-on "s")
```

Usage

Let us explore some examples that demonstrate the functions available in the s.el library.

Whitespace functions

The s-trim function can be used to remove whitespace at the beginning or end of a string. A few examples are shown below:

```
(s-trim " Hello, World")
"Hello, World"
```

```
(s-trim "Hello, World ")
"Hello, World"
```

```
(s-trim " Hello,      World ")
"Hello,      World"
```

If you want to remove whitespace at the beginning of the string only, you can use the s-trim-left function as follows:

```
(s-trim-left "Emacs Lisp ")
"Emacs Lisp "
```

```
(s-trim-left " Emacs Lisp ")
"Emacs Lisp "
```

The s-trim-right function can be used to remove whitespace at the end of a string. A couple of examples are shown below:

```
(s-trim-right " Conference")
```

```
" Conference"
```

```
(s-trim-right "Conference ")
"Conference"
```

The trailing control characters \n, \r or \r\n can be removed using the s-chomp function. Note that, if you have multiple newlines at the end of the string, only the last one entry is chopped.

```
(s-chomp "Excuse me\n")
"Excuse me"
```

```
(s-chomp "Excuse me\r\n")
"Excuse me"
```

```
(s-chomp "Excuse me\n\n")
"Excuse me"
"
```

Multiple whitespaces can be trimmed to a single whitespace using the s-collapse-whitespace function as illustrated below:

```
(s-collapse-whitespace "I really appreciate... ")
"I really appreciate... "
```

You can wrap words that go beyond a size N (a number) using the s-word-wrap function. For example:

```
(s-word-wrap 10 "This is a very long sentence")
"This is a
very long
sentence"
```

A text can be centred using the s-center function with whitespace on either end as shown below:

```
(s-center 5 "God")
" God "
```

If you need to add padding to the left or right, you can use the s-pad-left and s-pad-right functions respectively. A couple of examples to demonstrate the use of this function are given